SkillNavora

HANDBOOK 3

AMPscript, HTML email and CloudPages basics

Syntax, variables, data extension lookups, responsive email and the code explained line by line.

Salesforce Marketing Cloud (SFMC) Academy. Verify product names, editions, licences and certifications on Salesforce's official pages.

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Edition: November 2026. Practice labs marked "account" need a provisioned Marketing Cloud account. Other labs use sample files or paper.

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Module 8: Content Builder and Email Development

Level: Beginner to intermediate. Content Builder assets, responsive email design and dynamic content.

Module 8

8.1 Content Builder assets and naming

WHAT IS IT?

> Content Builder stores emails, images, content blocks and templates in folders. Naming conventions make assets findable and safe to reuse.

WHY IS IT IMPORTANT?

> Teams lose time looking for assets, and reused blocks change without warning if the naming and sharing are wrong.

HOW DOES IT WORK AND THE STEPS

1. Create folders by brand, campaign type and year.
2. Name blocks with a prefix such as blk_footer_brandA.
3. Use shared content blocks for footers and legal text.

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

> blk_footer_brandA is used in 40 emails; one edit updates them all.

COMMON ERRORS

Editing a shared block without checking every email that uses it.

INTERVIEW QUESTION

How would you organise Content Builder for three brands?

HANDS-ON EXERCISE

Design a folder and naming structure for two brands.

OFFICIAL DOCUMENTATION AND FURTHER READING

- Salesforce Help: Marketing Cloud Engagement

8.2 Responsive HTML email

WHAT IS IT?

Email HTML uses table-based layouts, inline CSS and media queries for mobile. Email clients have different support, so test in several clients.

WHY IS IT IMPORTANT?

Most emails are opened on phones; a layout that breaks on mobile loses clicks.

HOW DOES IT WORK AND THE STEPS

1. Use a single-column table layout with a maximum width of 600px.
2. Inline the key styles.
3. Use alt text on images and a text fallback for buttons.
4. Test on mobile and desktop clients.

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

A two-column layout collapses to one column below 480px using a media query.

CODE EXAMPLE, WITH LINE-BY-LINE NOTES

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<body style="margin:0;background:#f4f4f7;font-family:Arial,sans-serif">
<table role="presentation" width="100%" cellpadding="0" cellspacing="0"><tr><td align="center">
  <table role="presentation" width="600" style="max-width:600px;background:#ffffff">
    <tr><td style="padding:24px;text-align:center;font-size:22px;font-
weight:bold;color:#2b1a66">Your new offers</td></tr>
    <tr><td style="padding:0 24px 24px;font-size:16px;color:#1d1b2e">
      Hi %%=ProperCase(AttributeValue("FirstName"))=%%, here are picks for you.
    </td></tr>
    <tr><td align="center" style="padding:0 24px 32px">
      <a href="https://example.com/offer" style="background:#5b37c9;color:#ffffff;padding:12px
22px;text-decoration:none;border-radius:6px">See offers</a>
    </td></tr>
  </table>
</td></tr></table>
</body>
</html>
```

COMMON ERRORS

Relying on CSS features that many clients ignore.

INTERVIEW QUESTION

Why are email layouts built with tables?

HANDS-ON EXERCISE

Build a 600px responsive promotional email with a header, hero, two columns and a button.

OFFICIAL DOCUMENTATION AND FURTHER READING

- Campaign Monitor: HTML email guide

Module 9: AMPscript Programming

Level: Intermediate. AMPscript: syntax, variables, personalisation, data extension lookups and debugging.

Module 9

9.1 Syntax, variables and personalisation

WHAT IS IT?

> AMPscript runs on the server inside %%[...]%% blocks and prints values with %%=...=%%. SET assigns a variable; AttributeValue reads a subscriber attribute; ProperCase formats names.

WHY IS IT IMPORTANT?

> Almost every personalised SFMC email or CloudPage uses AMPscript.

HOW DOES IT WORK AND THE STEPS

1. Declare with VAR and assign with SET.
2. Print with %%= ... =%%.
3. Use AttributeValue for subscriber fields and provide a default in IIF or a check.

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

> Hello %%=ProperCase(AttributeValue("FirstName"))=%%.

CODE EXAMPLE, WITH LINE-BY-LINE NOTES

```
%%[
  VAR @first, @greeting
  SET @first = AttributeValue("FirstName")
  IF Empty(@first) THEN
    SET @greeting = "there"
  ELSE
    SET @greeting = ProperCase(@first)
  ENDIF
]%%
Hello %%=v(@greeting)=%%,
// Line by line: VAR declares the variables; SET reads the subscriber's first name;
// IF/ELSE chooses the fallback when the field is empty; v() prints the variable.
```

COMMON ERRORS

Printing an empty first name, which shows 'Hello ,'.

INTERVIEW QUESTION

What does AttributeValue return if the attribute is missing?

HANDS-ON EXERCISE

Write a greeting that falls back to 'there' if FirstName is empty.

OFFICIAL DOCUMENTATION AND FURTHER READING

- AMPscript guide (Salesforce docs)

Module 9

9.2 Data extension lookups

WHAT IS IT?

> Lookup returns one value from a data extension by matching a field. LookupRows returns a set of rows. RowCount counts them. Always handle the case when nothing is found.

WHY IS IT IMPORTANT?

> Lookups personalise messages from other data (orders, loyalty points) without a separate send.

HOW DOES IT WORK AND THE STEPS

1. Use Lookup('DataExtension','ReturnField','MatchField',value).
2. Check RowCount on LookupRows before looping.
3. Use the subscriber key or email address as the match value.

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

> Show the loyalty points for the subscriber's email.

CODE EXAMPLE, WITH LINE-BY-LINE NOTES

```
%%[
  VAR @tier
  SET @tier = Lookup("LoyaltyMembers", "Tier", "EmailAddress", emailaddr)
  IF Empty(@tier) THEN SET @tier = "Member" ENDIF
]%%
Your tier: %%=v(@tier)=%%
// Lookup matches EmailAddress to the subscriber email (emailaddr); if no row, @tier is empty and
the default is used.
```

COMMON ERRORS

Lookup on a field that is not unique and returns a random row.

INTERVIEW QUESTION

Explain Lookup and LookupRows.

HANDS-ON EXERCISE

Show the loyalty tier with a Lookup and a default when no row exists.

OFFICIAL DOCUMENTATION AND FURTHER READING

- AMPscript guide (Salesforce docs)

Module 10: HTML, CSS and JavaScript for SFMC

Level: Beginner to intermediate. The web basics needed for emails and CloudPages, and where JavaScript is used in SFMC.

Module 10

10.1 HTML and CSS essentials for SFMC

WHAT IS IT?

> HTML gives structure (headings, paragraphs, links, images, tables, forms). CSS gives style (colours, spacing, fonts). In email, styles must be inlined and tables used for layout.

WHY IS IT IMPORTANT?

> You cannot fix a broken email or landing page without these basics.

HOW DOES IT WORK AND THE STEPS

1. Learn tags: h1, p, a, img, table, tr, td.
2. Learn selectors and properties.
3. Inline styles for email clients.

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

> A link is an a tag with an href attribute.

COMMON ERRORS

Using div-based layouts in email.

INTERVIEW QUESTION

What is the difference between HTML and CSS?

HANDS-ON EXERCISE

Build a simple page with a heading, a paragraph and a link.

OFFICIAL DOCUMENTATION AND FURTHER READING

- MDN: HTML basics (official)

Module 10

10.2 JavaScript in CloudPages and forms

WHAT IS IT?

> JavaScript runs in the browser and can validate forms. Server-side JavaScript (SSJS) runs in SFMC for data work and is different from browser JavaScript. Keep secrets off the browser.

WHY IS IT IMPORTANT?

> Forms and interactive pages need validation before data is saved.

HOW DOES IT WORK AND THE STEPS

1. Validate the email format before submit.
2. Show error messages next to fields.
3. Use SSJS only where the platform supports it and check the docs.

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

> A registration form that checks the email format before posting.

COMMON ERRORS

Trusting browser validation alone; always validate on the server too.

INTERVIEW QUESTION

Where would you run JavaScript in an SFMC project?

HANDS-ON EXERCISE

Write a browser check for an email field.

OFFICIAL DOCUMENTATION AND FURTHER READING

- Salesforce Developer Documentation

Quick reference: AMPscript

Area	Items
AMPscript functions	VAR, SET, IF/ELSEIF/ELSE/ENDIF, FOR, Lookup, LookupRows, LookupOrderedRows, RowCount, Row, Field, InsertDE, UpdateDE, UpsertDE, DeleteDE, AttributeValue, ProperCase, Concat, Substring, Empty, v().